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A charged junction of profits, soaring rates

As your utility costs skyrocket, the firms and their top executives are prospering

By Sabrina Shankman

GLOBE STAFF

In 2025, as Massachusetts rate-payers forked over hundreds of dollars each month for gas and electric bills with some of the highest utility rates in the nation, Eversource notched a banner year.

The energy utility, one of two major providers in the state and one of the largest utilities in New England, posted \$1.69 billion in earnings — more than double what the company earned the year before.

It was also an especially good year for chief executive Joseph Nolan Jr., who has led the company since 2021. A recent SEC filing revealed his compensation — including salary, stock, annual bonus, and pension — reached \$15 million in 2025, more than 10 percent above the previous year.

Meanwhile, two other Eversource executives with seven-figure pay packages — chief financial officer John Moreira and James Hunt III, executive vice president of cor-

porate relations and sustainability — received a 20 percent bump in compensation, while a third had an 16 percent increase.

“What skills is [Nolan] bringing that somebody who costs half as much wouldn’t bring?” said Vick Mohanka, director of the Sierra Club’s Massachusetts chapter. “This is a choice we’re making to make one person, one company, extravagantly rich off of our higher rates. ... Do people feel right about that? Do we feel warm and fuzzy?”

There is increased scrutiny of executive pay at the nation’s utilities as states grapple with sky-high energy costs and little relief in sight. Executive compensation for utility CEOs often reaches into eight figures, and Nolan’s compensation is by no means a curve buster by national standards. But his now-higher pay comes as many customers rage over Eversource having among the highest rates in the nation.

Rates are similarly high at Na-

\$15m

Total 2025 compensation for Eversource chief executive Joseph Nolan Jr., a 10 percent increase from last year

UTILITIES, Page A10

Wu asks for \$70m to plug deficits

Mayor’s bid to use reserve funds for city, BPS budgets raises some concerns

By Niki Griswold

GLOBE STAFF

After months of warning about looming financial challenges, Mayor Michelle Wu said Monday she wants to pull \$70 million from Boston’s reserve funds to plug deficits in the city’s and Boston Public Schools’ budgets.

The maneuver, while not without precedent, raised concerns with some budget watchers about the city’s financial health, particularly as revenue growth from new commercial development slows.

Of the \$69.9 million in reserve funds Wu is seeking to use, most of it — about \$47 million — would cover a deficit in Boston’s operating budget city officials said was caused by higher-than-expected spending on snow removal this year. That amounts to roughly 1 percent of the city’s current \$4.8 billion budget.

The remaining \$22.8 million would bridge a gap in the BPS budget created by surging health insurance and utility costs, according to letters Wu sent to the City Council on Monday, requesting their approval to make the transfers.

The city had about \$1.2 billion in reserve funds as of the end of June last year, according to city officials.

BUDGET, Page A6



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Markley Group data center, shown in a drone image, dominates several backyards on Iowa Street in Lowell.

Residents yank welcome mat for new neighbors: data centers

The hulking facilities are loud and smelly, they say; officials are taking notice

By Hiawatha Bray

GLOBE STAFF

LOWELL — The Markley Group data center looms over Jake Fortes’s backyard like a nosy neighbor.

Back in the day, a spaghetti factory stood here. Today an ominous black cube of corrugated concrete towers about four stories high. Alongside it is a smaller cinderblock structure, its roof covered with cooling fans and four diesel generators, each the size of a railroad locomotive.

Before Markley arrived in 2015, “we had a view of Lowell from the back of our house,” Fortes said. “We could see the fireworks.”

Now, he said, when the diesels and cooling fans come to life, a droning, roaring racket and clouds of smoke saturate the neighborhood.

That’s why Fortes and his neighbors are fighting Markley’s efforts to grow its footprint in Lowell. They won a key victory in April, when the City Council approved a one-year moratorium on expanding the facility. They’re working with environmental advocates on a lawsuit to halt further expansion.

Similar battles are being fought across the nation and all over New England.

In Bristol, Conn., citizens are fighting a

proposed data center; Smithfield, R.I., passed a total ban; and Maine’s Legislature in April approved an 18-month ban on large data centers. Governor Janet Mills vetoed the bill because it didn’t make an exception for an already approved data center in the town of Jay that’s expected to generate hundreds of new jobs.

As companies spend billions on data centers to drive cloud computing services and the latest artificial intelligence systems, many elected officials, environmentalists, and homeowners say the centers bring few benefits to a community and impose many burdens.

DATA CENTERS, Page A7

Moulton dodges endorsement of Maine’s Platner

Candidates share histories, traits but differ on tactics

By Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

US Representative Seth Moulton built a national profile by bucking fellow Democratic leaders and helping fellow veterans turn once-red congressional seats blue.

That makes Moulton’s current political pursuit — running for US Senate — very much on brand, with one seeming exception: Neither Moulton nor his vets-focused PAC has endorsed Graham Platner, a fellow military veteran who captured attention by — stop if this sounds familiar — bucking fellow Democratic leaders and trying to turn a red Senate seat blue.

As Moulton makes his own case to take Senator Ed Markey’s seat, he has simultaneously backed nearly a dozen service members across the country — all of whom are running for US House, not Senate — but has declined so far to support the one running for a Senate seat widely viewed as the best pickup opportunity for Democrats this fall.

Like Moulton, Platner is a Marine. And like Moulton, the 41-year-old oysterman is waging his

MOULTON, Page A7

For Trump backers, \$1.8b

The Justice Dept. says the fund will help compensate those who claim they were targeted by the Biden administration; critics say it’s a political slush fund bankrolled by taxpayers. **A2.**

Gunmen stormed a mosque in San Diego, killing a guard and two other people. **A2.**

Economically challenged Syria seizes an opportunity to offer a land route for oil, allowing Gulf states to bypass the Strait of Hormuz. **A3.**

Mark Fuhrman has died. The Los Angeles detective was discredited during O.J. Simpson’s 1995 murder trial. **C9.**

Suspect preyed on women, prosecutor says

Trial opens for attorney general’s brother, accused in series of rapes

By Shelley Murphy

GLOBE STAFF

Night after night for nearly three years, Alvin Campbell Jr. drove around Boston, targeting young women who “had too much drink” and who would climb into the backseat of his SUV mistakenly believing he was a rideshare driver, a prosecutor told jurors Monday.

“He was looking for women he could rape,” said Assistant District Attorney Erin Murphy during opening statements in Campbell’s trial in Suffolk Superior Court. “Women who had drank so much that they wouldn’t be able to protect themselves. Women who were so far gone that he could get them into his car.”

Campbell, 45, the older brother of Massachusetts Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell, is charged with raping six women, indecent assault and battery on another woman, as well as kidnapping and secretly recording the attacks on his cellphone.

CAMPBELL, Page A6



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Alvin Campbell Jr.’s lawyer countered the women engaged in consensual sex.



Hot air balloons

Tuesday: Possible record heat.
High 93-98, low 72-77.

Wednesday: Hot, late storm.
High 89-94, low 53-58.
High tide: 1:18, 2:04.
Sunrise: 5:19. Sunset: 8:03.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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